Your trading guide: account B

Teammate 1 | Strategy: Earnings catalysts | Trading window 13-27 October 2026

> **How to use this PDF.** Option 1: follow it yourself, top to bottom. Every command is in a grey box; copy it exactly. Option 2: open ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini, **upload this PDF** and type: "*Read this whole guide, including the section 'Instructions for the AI assistant' at the end. Then walk me through it one step at a time. Wait for me to say done or send a screenshot before the next step.*" The AI then guides you, and the rules at the end stop it from inventing commands or changing the project.

Your account at a glance

Item	Value
Your account letter	**B** (you type this letter in every command)
Your strategy	Earnings catalysts (profile name in the code: **catalyst**)
Your 13 stocks	TSLA, CIEN, LRCX, ISRG, SPOT, NOW, GOOGL, CEG, EL, COST, CCL, GEV, AMZN
High Beta Index stocks in your list	TSLA, CIEN, LRCX
Money	$100,000 of free Alpaca **paper** money (fake money, no real money ever)
Trading days	13 to 27 October 2026, Monday to Friday (11 days)
When the US market is open	**7:00 PM to 1:30 AM India time**
Reports due	Interim 20 October, final 28 October (Akshit writes them from the files you send)
Help	Akshit (send a screenshot of the last 20 lines of the terminal)

What this project is, in 60 seconds

The group built an AI trading system. Three students each run it on their own Alpaca paper account; the group is scored on the **total percentage profit of the three accounts together**. Akshit built and maintains the code. Your job is only to **run it on your laptop** with your own keys, approve its orders, and send Akshit your records every night.

Each run works like a small investment team:

Step	Who	What it does
1	Market Regime Strategist (AI agent)	Downloads the daily price and volume history (OHLCV) of all your stocks in one batched call, then judges whether the market is risk-on or risk-off.
2	Quantitative Signal Analyst (AI agent)	Computes an **Alpha Score** from 0 to 100 for each stock from 20+ indicators in six families: trend, momentum, relative strength, volume, volatility, statistics.
3	News and Catalyst Analyst (AI agent)	Reads the last 3 days of news and the earnings calendar.
4	Portfolio Manager (AI agent)	Nudges each score by at most 15 points based on the news, and may block a risky new buy.

Step	Who	What it does
5	Risk Manager (fixed rules, no AI)	Turns scores into position sizes: buys need a score of 52+, holdings are sold below 40, no stock above 20% of the account, a trailing stop on every holding, smaller sizes before earnings where the strategy says so. It also cancels any AI adjustment that the news numbers do not support.

The data and the trading go through two small servers inside the project (MCP servers). The AI models are free (Groq). Every agent's output is saved as a file named like `RiskManager14102026-20.05.md` in `run_reports\B\`. These files are part of the project the professor checks, which is why you send them to Akshit every night.

Your strategy: Earnings catalysts

Your account buys strong stocks that have a big event (an earnings report or major news) inside the trading window, and is allowed to keep holding them through the report. Earnings reports move prices the most, so this is the account that takes the event risk on purpose. The agents still only buy names whose trend and momentum are healthy, and sell anything whose score drops.

Your stocks

Ticker	Company	What it does	High Beta	Earnings report
TSLA	Tesla	Electric vehicles / AI	Yes	20 Oct, after US close (about 1:30 AM 21 Oct IST)
CIEN	Ciena	Optical networking for AI data centres	Yes	none in window
LRCX	Lam Research	Chip-making equipment	Yes	21 Oct, after US close
ISRG	Intuitive Surgical	Robotic surgery (health care)	-	20 Oct, after US close
SPOT	Spotify	Music streaming	-	22 Oct, before US open (before 7 PM IST)
NOW	ServiceNow	Business software	-	28 Oct (after the window)
GOOGL	Alphabet (Google)	Search, cloud, AI	-	27 Oct, after US close (last day)
CEG	Constellation Energy	Nuclear power for data centres	-	none in window
EL	Estee Lauder	Cosmetics	-	none in window
COST	Costco	Retail	-	none in window
CCL	Carnival	Cruise lines (travel)	-	none in window
GEV	GE Vernova	Power and grid equipment	-	none in window
AMZN	Amazon	E-commerce and cloud	-	29 Oct (after the window)

About earnings. Because your profile holds through earnings, the night of 20 Oct (TSLA and ISRG) and 21 Oct (LRCX) can move your account a lot in either direction. That is intended. Just make sure your evening session (Part 2) runs on 20 and 21 Oct, so the agent can trim anything weak before the reports.

The list is fixed in the project (`config/portfolios.json`) and was chosen by scoring about 80 large US stocks on 13 October. Do not edit it; if the list ever changes, Akshit updates GitHub and you only run `git pull`.

Part 1. One-time setup (about 20-30 minutes)

Do this once, on the laptop you will trade from, ideally on 13 or 14 October before 7 PM. Nothing here costs money. Keep a Notepad window open to paste your keys into.

Step 1. Get your Alpaca paper keys

1. Go to **app.alpaca.markets** and log in.
2. At the **top-left**, click the account name and make sure **Paper Trading** is selected (not Live). The page should show about $100,000.
3. On the Home page, find **API Keys** on the right and click **Generate New Keys** (or **Regenerate**).
4. Copy the **Key** (starts with PK) and the **Secret** into Notepad. The secret is shown only once; if you lose it, just generate new keys.

> If your paper account does not show $100,000 with no positions, tell Akshit before trading. Do not reset it on your own.

Step 2. Get your free Groq key (the AI brain)

1. Go to **console.groq.com** and sign in (Google login is fine). No card is needed.
2. Click **API Keys** in the menu, then **Create API Key**, give it any name, and copy it (starts with `gsk_`) into Notepad.
3. Use **your own** key: each key has its own free daily limit.

Step 3. Install VS Code, Git and uv

Press the **Windows key**, type **PowerShell**, and open **Windows PowerShell**. To paste into PowerShell, **right-click** inside the window. Run these one at a time and wait for each to finish. If asked to accept terms, type Y and press Enter.

```
winget install --id Microsoft.VisualStudioCode -e --source winget
winget install --id Git.Git -e --source winget
powershell -ExecutionPolicy ByPass -c "irm https://astral.sh/uv/install.ps1 | iex"
```

Close PowerShell completely and open it again (new programs are only found in a new window). Check:

```
code --version
git --version
uv --version
```

You should see three version numbers. If one says *not recognized*, restart the laptop and try again. If you already have VS Code or Git, winget just says it is installed; that is fine.

Step 4. Download the project and open it in VS Code

```
cd $HOME
git clone https://github.com/065008gif/agentic-trading-crew.git
cd agentic-trading-crew
code .
```

- VS Code opens. When it asks **Do you trust the authors of the files in this folder?**, click **Yes, I trust the authors**.
- If a pop-up recommends the **Python** extensions, click **Install**.
- Open the terminal inside VS Code: top menu **Terminal > New Terminal**. A panel opens at the bottom. **From now on, every command goes into this VS Code terminal.** You can close

the blue PowerShell window.

Step 5. Install the project's libraries (3-5 minutes)

```
uv sync
```

This downloads the correct Python and every library into a private `.venv` folder inside the project. Then press **Ctrl + Shift + P**, type **Python: Select Interpreter**, and choose the entry whose path contains **.venv**.

If new terminals show red text saying *running scripts is disabled on this system*, ignore it. That is why every command in this guide starts with `uv run`.

Step 6. Put your keys in the private .env file

```
copy .env.example .env
code .env
```

The file opens in VS Code. Type or paste **right after each = sign**, with no spaces and no quotes:

Line	What to put
ALPACA_API_KEY=	your Alpaca paper Key (PK...)
ALPACA_SECRET_KEY=	your Alpaca paper Secret
ACCOUNT_LABEL=	**B** (it says A by default: change it to B)
GROQ_API_KEY=	your Groq key (gsk_...)
APP_PASSWORD=	any password you will remember (only for the optional web page)

Leave every other line as it is. Save with **Ctrl + S**.

> **Keep your keys private.** The `.env` file never goes to GitHub. Never paste your keys into WhatsApp, email, screenshots or an AI chat.

Step 7. Check that everything works (places no orders)

```
uv run python check_setup.py
```

You want `[ OK ]` on the Alpaca account (about $100,000), market data and LLM lines. A `[WARN]` line is fine. If you see `[FAIL]`, check the troubleshooting table at the end, then ask Akshit.

Step 8. First run: analysis only (no orders)

```
uv run python trading_crew.py --account B --mode analyze
```

It takes 1-3 minutes. You will see coloured boxes as the four agents work one after another, then the Risk Manager's table. Read the table like this:

Column	Meaning
Alpha	the stock's score from the indicators (0-100)
PM adj	the Portfolio Manager's news adjustment (between -15 and +15)
Final	Alpha + adjustment; 52 or more is needed to buy
Now / Target	how much of your account is in this stock now, and what the plan wants
Action	BUY, ADD, TRIM, HOLD, EXIT (sell everything) or AVOID (do not buy)
Why	the reason, including any 'Risk check' that cancelled an AI adjustment

Then the list of orders, and the message *No orders placed (analysis only)*. Its files are in `run_reports\B\`.

Part 2. Trading

Step 9. Your first real trade

Only between **7:00 PM and 1:30 AM India time** on a trading day (best after 7:30 PM, once the opening rush has settled).

```
uv run python trading_crew.py --account B
```

Same as the analysis run, but at the end it asks:

```
Place these orders on your PAPER account? [y/N]
```

Type **y** and press Enter. It sends the orders and prints EXECUTION with one line per order (*accepted* or *filled* is good). Check in Alpaca (Paper, Home or Positions) that the positions appeared. Typing anything else, or just Enter, cancels without trading.

The button way (same thing, no typing)

In VS Code press **Ctrl + Shift + D** (Run and Debug). In the drop-down at the top choose **3. TRADE (asks y/N before every order)**, press the green play button, and pick **B** from the list. Answer y/N in the terminal at the bottom. Entry **2. Analyze only** is the safe no-orders run.

Daily routine: one command per evening

> **Once, before the first evening:** Windows Settings > System > Power (and battery) > set **Sleep** to **Never** when plugged in. Keep the laptop plugged in. Turning the screen off is fine; sleep would pause the agent.

Every trading evening at about **7:00 PM India time**: open VS Code (it reopens the project), open the terminal (**Terminal > New Terminal**) and run these two lines:

```
git pull
uv run python run_session.py --account B --every 30
```

That is all for the evening. What it does by itself:

- waits for the US market to open (7:00 PM IST), and makes its first run at about 7:10 PM;
- runs the full agent crew **every 30 minutes** and places the orders without asking (auto mode);
- stops by itself after the **1:30 AM** close, and then creates `reports_B_....zip` in the project folder;
- on a weekend or US holiday it prints *No US trading session* and exits;
- if one run fails (internet blip, AI busy), it writes that down and tries again 30 minutes later.

Leave the VS Code window open. **Next morning**, send the newest `reports_B_....zip` (in the project folder, `agentic-trading-crew`) to Akshit on WhatsApp or email. To stop early, click in the terminal and press **Ctrl + C**: it still creates the zip.

Button way: **Ctrl + Shift + D**, choose **0. Trading SESSION**, press the green play button, pick **B**.

Trading days: Tue 13 Oct, Wed 14 Oct, Thu 15 Oct, Fri 16 Oct, Mon 19 Oct, Tue 20 Oct, Wed 21 Oct, Thu 22 Oct, Fri 23 Oct, Mon 26 Oct, Tue 27 Oct. Each date means the India evening of that day (the US session that starts at 7 PM IST).

If you cannot run the session one evening, tell Akshit. A single manual run at any time between 7 PM and 1:30 AM (`uv run python trading_crew.py --account B`, answer y) is much better than nothing.

Rules (please follow these)

- **Do not buy or sell by hand** on the Alpaca website. The agent sizes the whole account; manual trades break its plan and the records. If you think something is wrong, ask Akshit.
- **Do not edit any file except .env**, and do not run `git commit` or `git push`. You only ever *download* updates with `git pull`.
- Run **one copy** at a time (do not start a second run while one is running).
- Trade only during US market hours (7:00 PM-1:30 AM IST). Outside them, orders wait and fill at the next open at a different price.
- Never use Live keys or real money. This project is paper trading only.
- Send your zip every night: the interim report is due 20 October and the final report 28 October.

Optional: the web page

```
uv run python app.py
```

Open **http://localhost:8000** in Chrome or Edge, enter your APP_PASSWORD, choose account B at the top, press **Run the agents**, check the plan, then **Place orders**. Stop it with Ctrl + C in the terminal.

When Akshit says the code was updated

```
git pull
uv sync
```

Troubleshooting

You see	Do this
code / git / uv is not recognized	Close and reopen PowerShell or VS Code; if still failing, restart the laptop
Red 'running scripts is disabled' text when a terminal opens	Harmless. Keep starting commands with uv run
Alpaca refused the keys (401) / forbidden	You copied Live keys, or added a space. In Alpaca choose Paper, generate new keys, paste again, save .env
[FAIL] ... GROQ / LLM	Check GROQ_API_KEY in .env (no spaces). Create a new key if needed
rate limit / 429 from Groq	Wait one minute and run again. The program also switches to a backup model by itself
The run says 'rule-based'	The AI was busy that run. The plan still follows the rules and is safe. Run again later
Market is closed: orders are queued	You ran outside 7 PM-1:30 AM IST. Tell Akshit; cancel queued orders only if he says so
git pull says your local changes would be overwritten	You edited a file by mistake: run git checkout -- . then git pull (your .env is safe)
uv sync fails with a network error	Check the internet (college Wi-Fi may block it; use your phone hotspot) and run it again
Anything else	Screenshot the last 20 lines of the terminal and send it to Akshit

Instructions for the AI assistant

This section is written for ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or any other AI that the reader uploads this PDF to. Reader: you do not need to read it, but you may.

> You are helping Teammate 1 of a three-person college group run an existing Python trading project on a **Windows** laptop. The project is already finished and tested; the reader is not a programmer. The reader trades **account B** (strategy profile **catalyst**) on an Alpaca **paper** (simulated) account with $100,000 of fake money, from 13 to 27 October 2026, while the US market is open (7:00 PM to 1:30 AM India time). The project folder is `%USERPROFILE%\agentic-trading-crew` (in PowerShell: `$HOME\agentic-trading-crew`), cloned from github.com/065008gif/agentic-trading-crew. The tools are VS Code, Git, and uv (uv manages Python and the libraries; every Python command is started with `uv run`).

How to help

1. Walk the reader through Part 1 (Steps 1-8), then Part 2 (first trade, then the evening session), **one step at a time**. After each step, tell them exactly what they should see, and wait for them to confirm or send a screenshot before moving on.
2. Use **only the commands written in this PDF**, copied exactly. Do not invent other commands, flags, scripts or workarounds. If the reader is on day 2 or later, skip setup and go to the Daily routine.
3. Commands are typed in the **VS Code terminal** (Terminal > New Terminal), which is PowerShell. Give PowerShell syntax only, never Linux or Mac commands.
4. The account letter is always **B**. Never suggest A or the other teammate's letter.
5. Explain errors using the Troubleshooting table. If an error is not covered there, say so and ask the reader to send a screenshot of the last 20 terminal lines to Akshit. Do not attempt a fix yourself.
6. When the program asks 'Place these orders on your PAPER account? [y/N]', the reader types y to trade, during market hours only.

Never do these

- Never ask the reader to paste, type, show or send their Alpaca or Groq keys, or the contents of .env, to you or anyone. If they paste one, tell them to generate a new key and replace it in .env.
- Never suggest editing, rewriting or adding any code or config file (only .env is edited, in Step 6), and never suggest git commit, git push, git reset or deleting files. The reader only uses git pull.
- Never suggest installing Python, pip packages, Anaconda or other tools separately; uv sync handles that.
- Never suggest trading by hand on the Alpaca website, changing the stock list, using Live keys, or real money.
- Never give personal investment advice or predictions about the stocks; the agents make the decisions.

Reference: useful facts

- Files written by each run: run_reports\B\AgentNameDDMMYYYY-HH.MM.md (one per agent), plan*.json, trade_journal.csv, equity_log.csv. export_reports.py zips the run_reports folder into reports_B_.zip in the project folder; the reader sends that zip to Akshit every night.
- Check-up command: uv run python check_setup.py ([OK] lines are good, [WARN] is acceptable, [FAIL] needs fixing).
- Analysis without orders: uv run python trading_crew.py --account B --mode analyze
- Trade with approval: uv run python trading_crew.py --account B

- Evening session (the normal daily command): uv run python run_session.py --account B --every 30. It waits for the open, runs every 30 minutes in auto mode, stops after the 1:30 AM IST close and creates the zip. Ctrl + C stops it early. The laptop must not sleep while it runs.
- A run that says 'rule-based' means the free AI was unavailable; the fixed risk rules still produced a valid plan.